

NAVIGATOR KIDS: WAVE RIDER ADVENTURE

A Field Guide for Ocean Explorers

MISSION LOG:

Explorer Name: _____

Dive Date: _____

IDENTIFY YOUR OCEAN SUPER POWER:

(Check all that apply to your Brain)

☐ **The Deep Diver:** I love learning *everything* about things I like.

☐ **The Storm Watcher:** I notice changes in the room before anyone else.

☐ **The Fast Fish:** My brain moves super fast!

☐ **The Empath:** I feel other people's feelings like waves.

CURRENT OCEAN CONDITIONS:

Sometimes, the ocean is calm. Sometimes, it is stormy. Having a Super Brain means you might feel the storms more than other turtles. That is okay! We are going to learn to surf.

Are you ready to dive in?

☐ YES ☐ COWABUNGA!

Page 2: The Story – Shelly’s Splashy Day

Meet Shelly.

Shelly is a Sea Turtle who loves the ocean. She loves the bright coral reefs and the warm sun. But sometimes, the ocean gets **TOO LOUD** and **TOO BUSY**.

When the waves get big, Shelly feels like she is spinning in a washing machine.

- Her heart beats fast.
- Her shell feels tight.
- Her brain feels "Fizzy".

She wants to hide in her shell, but she really wants to stay and play. She needs to learn how to ride the waves instead of letting them crash on her!

YOUR TURN:

Draw what a "Stormy Day" looks like inside your head. Is it messy scribbles? Lightning bolts? A giant wave?

Page 3: Surf Skill #1 – The Wave Check

THE PROBLEM:

You can't surf a wave if you don't know how big it is! Sometimes a small problem feels HUGE because our brains are amplifiers.

THE SOLUTION:

We need to measure the wave.

Activity: The Wave Meter

Look at the waves below. Color them in to match how you feel right now (or how you felt during your last storm).

Wave 1 (Tiny Ripple): I am calm and cool. 😎

(Color Blue)

Wave 2 (Small Splash): I am a little annoyed or wiggly. 😏

(Color Green)

Wave 3 (Bumpy Ride): I am frustrated or worried. 😞

(Color Yellow)

Wave 4 (Big CRASH): I am mad or scared! 😡

(Color Orange)

Wave 5 (TSUNAMI!): I am exploding! 💣

(Color Red)

My Wave Number is: _____

Pro Tip: If you are at a Level 5, stop talking and start Breathing!

Page 4: Surf Skill #2 – Starfish Breathing

THE PROBLEM:

When the waves get big, your brain forgets how to breathe. It takes short, tiny breaths, which tells your heart to beat faster!

THE SOLUTION:

We need to turn your hand into a Starfish to guide your breath.

Activity: The Hand Trace

Place your hand on the paper below (or use the drawing).

Instructions:

1. Spread your fingers out like a Starfish.
2. Take your pointer finger from the other hand.
3. **Trace UP** your thumb -> **Breathe IN** (Smell the sea air) 🌊
4. **Trace DOWN** your thumb -> **Breathe OUT** (Blow the bubbles) 🐬
5. Keep going for all 5 fingers!

Challenge:

Can you do it with your eyes closed?

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

Page 5: Surf Skill #3 – Shake Like a Fish

THE PROBLEM:

Big feelings create "Fizzy Energy" inside your muscles. It feels like having soda pop in your arms and legs. If you don't let it out, you might explode!

THE SOLUTION:

You have to wiggle the fizz out!

Activity: The Wiggle Zone

Stand up! We are going to shake the "Fizz" out of our bodies.

1. **Shake your hands** (Get the crabs off!) 🦀
2. **Stomp your feet** (Splash the puddles!) 🦶
3. **Wiggle your whole body** like a wet dog or a floppy fish! 🐟

Paper Activity:

Below is a "Fizzy Storm." Use your pencil to scribble over it as fast and messy as you can until it is all gone!

Did the fizz go away? [] Yes [] A little bit

Page 6: The Science – The Ocean Brain

Why do we feel so much?

Inside your brain, there are two important sea creatures:

1. The Crab (Amygdala)

The Crab is your protector. It has big pinchers! When it sees danger (or a big wave), it pinches the alarm button. It doesn't think; it just reacts! *Snip snap!*

2. The Dolphin (Prefrontal Cortex)

The Dolphin is the smart leader. It knows how to solve problems, use words, and be a good friend.

The Glitch:

When the Crab gets scared by a Big Wave, it pinches the Dolphin! The Dolphin swims away to safety. That is why you can't "listen" when you are upset—your Dolphin is gone!

How the Tools Help:

- **Starfish Breathing:** Tells the Crab, "We are safe." The Crab lets go.
- **Shaking:** Uses up the Crab's energy so it gets tired and naps.
- **Result:** The Dolphin swims back to help you!

Page 7: Scenario Challenge

Situation:

Shelly is building a sandcastle. A big wave comes and washes it away.

Her face gets hot. Her Crab is waking up! She wants to throw her shovel.

Wave Check: She is at a **Level 4** (Big Crash!).

What should Shelly do?

Option A: Scream at the ocean and kick the sand. (The Crab is in charge).

Option B: Hold her breath and pretend she is fine. (The Fizz stays inside).

Option C: Use her Surf Skills.

Let's help Shelly use Option C!

1. **Shake:** She stands up and shakes her flippers to get the mad feelings out.
2. **Starfish:** She sits down and traces her flipper. *Up... Down... Up... Down...*
3. **Result:** Her wave goes down to a Level 2. Her Dolphin comes back. She says, "I can build a new one, even bigger!"

Draw a medal for Shelly here:

Page 8: Parent & Crew Chief Guide

The Science of Emotional Regulation

For neurodivergent children (2e/ADHD/Autism), emotional regulation is a biological challenge, not a behavioral choice.

1. Metacognition (Wave Check):

2e children often have poor "Interoception" (sensing internal states). They go from Calm (1) to Meltdown (5) instantly. The "Wave Check" helps them learn to identify the middle steps (2, 3, and 4) so they can intervene early.

2. Tactile Anchoring (Starfish Breathing):

Asking a dysregulated child to "just breathe" often fails because their working memory is offline. Tracing the hand provides a *somatosensory anchor*. The physical sensation grounds them, making the breathing exercise effective.

3. Somatic Discharge (Shake It Out):

The "fight or flight" response dumps cortisol and adrenaline into the bloodstream. Sitting still makes this worse. "Shaking" completes the stress cycle, physically burning off the stress hormones so the body can return to safety.

Quick Script for Parents:

- *Don't ask:* "Why are you acting like this?" (The Dolphin is gone, they don't know).
- *Do say:* "I see a Big Wave coming. Let's do Starfish hands together."

| 🌊 WAVE CHECK | ★ STARFISH BREATH | | | | How big is it? | 1. Spread your hand. | | 1. Calm | 2. Trace UP (Breathe In). | | 2. Wiggly | 3. Trace DOWN (Breathe Out). | | 3. Bumpy | 4. Do all 5 fingers. | | 4. CRASH! (Use tools!) | | 5. TSUNAMI (Safety first!) | *Calm the Crab.* |

| 🐟 SHAKE IT OUT | 🏷️ NAME THE WAVE | | | | Got Fizzy Energy? | "I feel a MAD wave." | | 1. Wiggle hands. | "I feel a WORRIED wave." | | 2. Stomp feet. | | 3. Shake like a jelly! | *Name it to Tame it!* | | *Let the fizz go.* | |

CERTIFIED WAVE RIDER

This certifies that

Has learned the secrets of the ocean and can surf the big emotions.

You have mastered:

The Wave Check 

The Starfish Breath 

The Fishy Shake 

Remember: You can't stop the waves, but you can learn to surf!

Signed: _____ (Chief Oceanographer)

Date: _____